



M4 Sherman

Like the T-34 and Tiger, the Sherman's story is often clouded by myths and misinformation. The US had made just 365 modern tanks by the end of 1940, but had made 49,234 Shermans alone by the war's end—an amazing achievement, and one that should not be overlooked when comparing the Sherman with late-war German tanks on a one to one basis.

IN 1940, THE US DOCTRINE for the use of tanks centered around their role as weapons of exploitation—armored cavalry that could dash forward after a breakthrough and cause mayhem behind enemy lines. Designed in 1940 as the successor to the interim model M3 Lee medium tank, the Sherman met this criteria perfectly: it was speedy, and was armed with a good dual-purpose gun. It was also simple to maintain, reliable, and rugged. It was built in 11 different plants across the US, most of which had had no prior experience in tank manufacturing.

The Sherman soon proved itself well suited to the needs of World War II, and was made in a number of subvariants, adapted for many roles, and produced in such numbers (63,181, including derivatives) that it could arm the US, British and Commonwealth, Russian, and other Allied armies. The Sherman saw service in many nations' armies after World War II, and was still in service in Paraguay in 2016.



REAR VIEW



SPECIFICATIONS	
Name	M4A1 Sherman
Date	1940
Origin	US
Production	49,234
Engine	Wright-Continental R-975 radial gasoline, 400 hp
Weight	33.3 tons (30.2 tonnes)
Main armament	75 mm M3
Secondary armament	.30 Browning M1919 machine guns
Crew	5
Armor thickness	4.6 in (118 mm)

Loader

Commander

Gunner

Driver

Co-driver